

# INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA-PAKISTAN - 3

MODULE - 17

- In spite of the age-old and long standing enmity between neighbours, India and Pakistan have made attempts to resolve the disputes and establish cordial relations for the benefit of their economy and society and peace in South Asia.

Some of the recent initiatives are:

### POLITICAL

#### AGRA SUMMIT

- 1 In 2001, tension grew along the Line of Control and 38 people were killed in an attack on the Kashmir assembly in Srinagar.
- 2 Following the attack, the chief minister of Indian-administered Kashmir called on the Indian government to launch a full-scale military operation against alleged training camps in Pakistan.
- 3 In July, the President Musharraf and Prime Minister Vajpayee attended the Agra Summit.
- 4 In 2002, President Musharraf pledged that Pakistan would combat extremism on its own soil but affirmed that the country had the right to Kashmir.

## MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

- India and Pakistan have proven to be willing and able to partner regionally.
- They may struggle to coexist in SAARC, but they are both members of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation.

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### COMPOSITE DIALOGUE PROCESS

- Cooperation at SAARC was viewed as a hope to resolve the Indo-Pak disputes.

**1** At the 12th SAARC Summit in 2004, the Composite Dialogue Process began between India and Pakistan.

**2** Bilateral meetings took place at various levels of government. These exchanges culminated into reduction of troops at the Indo-Pak border.

**3** The fifth round of talks regarding the review of nuclear and ballistic missile related CBMs was held as part of the Composite Dialogue Process.

**4** The second round of the Joint Anti-Terrorism Mechanism (JATM) was also held.

## MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

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### TAPI

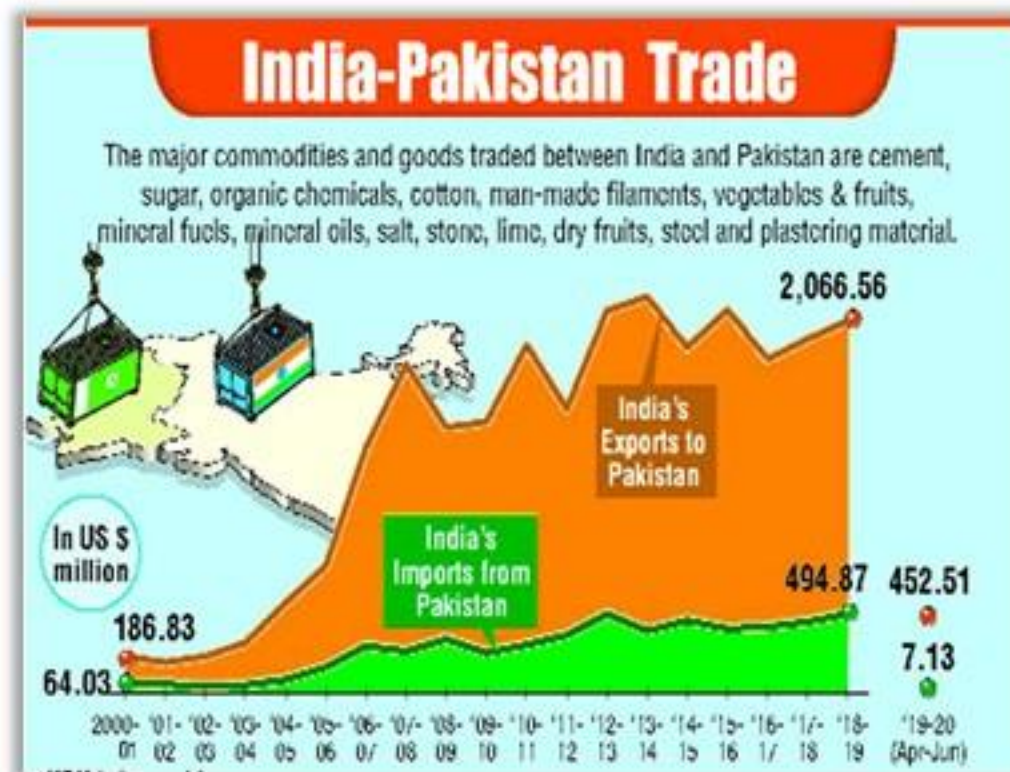
- In 2008, India joined a framework agreement between Turkmenistan, Afghanistan and Pakistan (TAPI) on a \$7.6bn gas pipeline project.
- In September, Pakistani President Zardari and Indian PM Singh formally announced the opening of several trade routes between the two countries.



## ECONOMIC

- In 1948-49- In spite of dispute of Kashmir, India was Pakistan's largest trading partner in the initial years after independence.
- India accounted for 56 per cent of Pakistan's exports, and Pakistan imports from India accounted for 32 per cent.

- 1 Between 1947 and 1965, the two sides concluded fourteen trade agreements.
- 2 In 1965- Indian banks continued to operate their branches in Pakistan even during the war.
- 3 Following that war, however, and the degree of antipathy generated on both sides in the aftermath of the 1971 war, trade relations between the two countries all but came to a standstill for over eight years.



## ECONOMIC

4 In September 2012-India curbed its list of restricted imports from Pakistan to just over 600.

5 Bilateral trade between India and Pakistan is estimated to be around US\$2.61 billion (\$3.4 billion) for the 2015-16 period.

6 The pragmatic consideration of need to maintain the basis of a good relationship prevailed. Both sides recognised that bilateral trade has the potential to reach US\$30 billion.

7 In 2019- the volume of trade between India and Pakistan grew by nearly five per cent. Pakistan's imports have a negative growth with almost all countries except India.



## ECONOMIC

### INFRASTRUCTURE FOR TRADE

- 1 Efficient and cost-effective transportation and communication is a pre-requisite for promotion of trade and commerce and movement of goods, services and people.
- 2 Poor transportation linkages make trade costly, with railway and road connections inadequate and sea shipments constrained by both limited port facilities and bureaucratic regulations and restrictions.



## ECONOMIC

### MEASURES TO IMPROVE TRADE

- 1 Easing the complexities in visa procedure should be taken into consideration by the two countries.
- 2 Progress in trade and economic cooperation with India and Pakistan would need a firm and a continuous commitment from Pakistani authorities.
- 3 India and Pakistan can learn from the global experience, where trade is increasingly being used as a prelude to age-old geo-political tensions



### INDUS WATER TREATY

### RIVER WATER SHARING

The Indus Water Treaty was signed in 1960 between PM Nehru and President Ayyub Khan.

#### AIM

Devise a solution to the sharing of waters of Indus and its tributaries.

#### FEATURES OF TREATY

- 1 India would govern Beas, Sutlej and Ravi and use it for irrigation and power generation.
- 2 Water would also be used for domestic, industrial and non-consumptive uses such as navigation.
- 3 India is allowed to use 20 percent water through irrigation, power generation and transportation.
- 4 Pakistan, on the other hand, governs Indus, Chenab and Jhelum.
- 5 The disputes that arise between India and Pakistan over this treaty are to be referred to a seven member arbitral tribunal called 'Court of Arbitration'.

## RIVER WATER SHARING

### SHORTCOMINGS OF TREATY

- 1 Division of water specially during shortage of water flow is not agreed upon signatory countries.
- 2 Impact of storage of water on Chenab river not clarified.
- 3 The technical aspects remain unaddressed.
- 4 Resolving water disputes is dependent upon the political will of the countries.
- 5 Pakistan feels that India is violating the treaty provisions by constructing hydroelectric projects Pakul Dul and Lower Kalnai in the Chenab Basin.



## CULTURAL

- Despite all the political differences, the citizens of both countries remain strongly interrelated and interconnected with each other through the same culture, same language, same dress, same weathers, same festivities and same traditions which are bonding them together despite the diplomatic differences promoted by the states.

**1** India and Pakistan share common cultural values in addition to divided families.

**2** The Indian film industry has a large following in Pakistan and Pakistani actors participate in Indian television programmes.

**3** Cricket is yet another common factor. The game is closely followed in both countries and approaches something of a religious fervour in India.

It has said that the cultural exchanges between the two countries should not fall prey to political relations. Engagement at the cultural, sporting and humanitarian levels should continue



## PEOPLE TO PEOPLE CONTACTS

### i KARTARPUR CORRIDOR

- 1 India and Pakistan announced plans to operationalise a visa-free corridor between Dera Baba Nanak in Punjab and Kartarpur Sahib in Pakistan.
- 2 In 1995, Pakistan renovated the Kartarpur Gurudwara on the banks of river Ravi. It is a 4-km long corridor and can become an example for cross-border exchanges based on faith.
- 3 Kashmiri Pandits have wanted to visit Sharda Peeth in PoK and the Sufis in Pakistan wished to visit the Moinuddin Chishti in Ajmer.
- 4 The move was to allow the Sikh pilgrims to attend the 550th Birth Anniversary of Guru Nanak in November 2019. India proposed building a passage for pilgrims accessible for 365 days of the year.
- 5 It is important that matters related to the corridor are handled in a non-political manner.



## PEOPLE TO PEOPLE CONTACTS

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### THAR LINK EXPRESS

- 1 The Agreement on Thar link was signed in 2006.
- 2 It is international passenger train to connect Khokhrapar in Pakistan and Munabao in Rajasthan, from Jodhpur to Sindh in Pakistan.
- 3 It will be the cheapest means of transport to facilitate people-to-people contact.



## ROAD AHEAD

- What does the future of India-Pakistan relation involve?
- Since India and Pakistan have been destined to stick to each other, it is imperative that the countries attempt to resolve their difference amicably for the future generations of the two countries to live a peaceful life. Some of the ways to achieve this are mentioned below:

- 1 India hopes to have peaceful resolution to the Kashmir issue through a bilateral approach.
- 2 Pakistan is internationalizing the issue and asking to hold a plebiscite for its people. This stand is rejected by India as India feels it is a direct violation of the Shimla Agreement of 1972.
- 3 If there is peace at the border and a solution for Kashmir is arrived upon, then the China Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) can ultimately benefit its people and economy. Moreover, Kashmir can act as the gateway for Central Asia.



## ROAD AHEAD

- 4 The TAPI and IPI pipeline can be extremely beneficial for Indian and Pakistani energy needs.
- 5 A solution to the problem of terrorism can benefit the internal security situation in India and Pakistan.
- 6 Good relations with Pakistan benefit India to get direct access to Afghanistan.
- 7 Cross-border terrorism is plaguing India and anti-Indian sentiments emanate from Pakistan. These anti-social activities need to be checked for restoration of peace and better relations



## ROAD AHEAD

- 8 Bilateral trade between both the countries will also result in more public revenues, since governments can earn more through custom revenues when smuggled items switch to formal trade.
- 9 India and Pakistan should create an atmosphere of peace to boost trade. Investment and major ventures can take place in a big way if both sides are able to create an enabling political environment of peace, trust and confidence.
- 10 India should wait for Pakistan to reset itself and concentrate on restoring normalcy in Jammu & Kashmir, mainstreaming the population, especially the youth, encourage investment in the state and keep a careful watch on what China might be planning.



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**For Suggestions:**

[suggestions@learningspace.in](mailto:suggestions@learningspace.in)

**To Contact us:**

[info@learningspace.in](mailto:info@learningspace.in)

**For Information:**

[info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com](mailto:info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com)

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